

- System design

What does the retry have permission for?

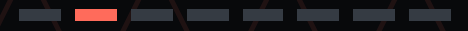
An approval diagram needs room for the returning arrow.



What still authorizes it?

A proposed design review.

- System design



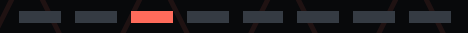
The reply can be lost after the action succeeds.

A timeout leaves the caller uncertain.
Repeating a request may repeat its effect.

No reply ≠ proof of no effect

Retry semantics: RFC 9110 §9.2.2.

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Ask whether it is the same intended action.

A repeated request and a new instruction can look similar. I would make the intent explicit.

01 Which action was approved?

02 What limits applied?

03 Do they still cover this request?

Approval scope is a separate check.

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Give the request an identity that survives.

Use the service's idempotency contract to identify a retry. Check how it treats changed parameters and expired records.

Same identifier?

Same intended effect?

Do not infer intent from matching text alone.

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The record needs to survive the failure too.

Writing “done” locally after the effect leaves a crash window. I would check how the effect and its record stay consistent.

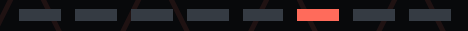
01 Inspect the service’s guarantees.

02 Reconcile uncertain outcomes.

03 Keep unresolved attempts visible.

A durable log alone does not ensure one effect.

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Then lose the reply on purpose.

In a controlled test, let the action take effect, suppress its response, then exercise the retry path.

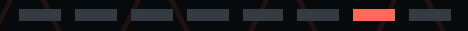
01 Count the actual effects.

02 Trace the approval used.

03 Inspect the returned result.

Suggested test; no deployment result claimed.

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Change the intent and test the boundary.

I would also try changed parameters, an expired approval and a late retry. The intended response should be explicit.

A familiar request can need a new decision.

Reauthorization depends on the actual scope.

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Draw the returning arrow
before trusting the
diagram.

I want to see how the same action is
recognised, how uncertain outcomes are
resolved, and where approval stops applying.

Reading: Malcolm Featonby,
[Making retries safe with idempotent
APIs.](#)

[RFC 9110 §9.2.2.](#)

Approval review: my proposed design
questions.